

Project Vitality

Problem Statement: How might Sri Venkateswara College, within eight months, design and implement a sustainable, student-led health initiative that improves dietary awareness, monitors food quality, and encourages healthier habits through education, testing, and actionable insights, despite limited resources and expert availability?

1. Context

Situation:

College students at Sri Venkateswara College often neglect their physical health due to irregular routines, poor diet choices, and lack of awareness about nutrition. Many rely on hostel or PG food, processed snacks, and caffeinated drinks, leading to fatigue, weight gain, and long-term health risks.

Complication:

Lack of health awareness and nutrition education.

No regular health check-ups or tracking mechanisms.

Students underestimate the role of diet and lifestyle in performance and well-being.

Cafeteria and PG food options are often unhygienic or nutritionally imbalanced.

2. Constraints

Limited budget for recurring health camps.

Lack of nutrition experts or certified health counsellors on campus.

Dependence on external partners for testing and data analysis.

Difficulty in sustaining student participation beyond initial enthusiasm.

3. Criteria for Success

Qualitative:

Higher awareness among students about calorie balance, nutrition labels, and healthy food habits.

Students able to make small, consistent dietary improvements.

Creation of a health-conscious environment on campus.

Quantitative:

Number of students attending health seminars or camps.

Number of PGs or canteens assessed for food hygiene and nutrition quality.

Measurable improvement in student health indicators (BMI, fatigue, self-reported energy).

4. Scope**Included:**

Seminars and workshops on nutrition and health education.

Health check-up or blood test camps.

Food audits in college canteens and PGs.

Campaigns to educate students on calorie awareness and simple diet swaps.

Not Included:

Medical treatment or individualised healthcare plans.

Policy changes in external PGs or vendors beyond assessment reports.

5. Stakeholders

Internal:

College students

Student Union

College Administration

Canteen/PG Vendors

External:

Nutritionists, dieticians, and doctors

NGOs or health-tech startups

Diagnostic labs

Local food safety authorities

6. Sources of Insight

Primary:

Surveys on eating habits and lifestyle patterns among students.

Interviews with canteen and PG food providers.

Assessment of nutritional information in available foods

Secondary:

WHO and Indian government reports on youth nutrition.

Case studies of college wellness programs.